STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			AU-5200
SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA GREG LONDON SHERIFF	DATE ISSUED 08/13/07	DATE REVISED **05/14/20**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
	APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE AUXILIARY UNITS: SEARCH AND RESCUE UNIT	RESOURCES		
SUBJECT SEARCH AND RESCUE UNIT STRUCTURE	CROSS REFERENCE G-1220 CHAIN OF COMMAND; G-5230 TRANSFER AND ASSIGNMENT; P-5000 HIGH RISK INCIDENTS; P-5010 HIGH RISK INCIDENT COMMAND		

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish the direct lines of supervision and responsibility for the Search and Rescue Unit and to establish the chain of command.

II. Policy:

A. The Search and Rescue Unit (SARU) shall be under the direct command of the Search and Rescue Unit Commander who shall have the rank of sergeant or higher. The SARU Commander shall be appointed by the Sheriff.

B. The SARU shall have a Team Leader who shall generally have the rank of sergeant or higher and who shall be under the supervision of the Unit Commander. The SARU Team Leader shall be appointed by the SARU Commander.

C. In the absence of the SARU Commander, the SARU Team Leader shall be in command of the Unit.

D. Individual Search and Rescue Unit members may be assigned supervision over other unit members during incidents and training. This assignment shall be made by the Unit Commander or Team Leader. This assignment may be made without regard to formal rank and those SARU members placed under the supervision of another SARU member shall follow the direction of that individual in accordance with Sheriff's Office policies regardless of rank (see G-1220 Chain of Command).

E. Under specific circumstances, the SARU Commander may be under the command of the High Risk Incident Commander as provided in policy (see P-5000 High Risk Incidents and P-5010 High Risk Incident Command).

F. Deputies selected for an assignment to the Search and Rescue Unit shall do so on a part-time basis with, or beyond, the normally assigned duties of their position.

As such, supervision for day-to-day activities shall be provided within the chain of command of those deputies' assigned divisions.

G. SARU members must be prepared for call-out at any time:

1. Each SARU member shall be notified by public service or text message.

2. When called out, unit members shall telephone the number indicated on their message or turn to the assigned radio channel and proceed per instructions to the designated location.

3. If a SARU member will be unavailable for call-out for a period of time exceeding twenty-four (24) hours (e.g. member is on vacation, will be out of town for training, etc.), he or she shall notify the SARU Commander.

H. Participation of SARU members in SARU related training shall be contingent upon the approval of their division commanders and with timely notification of immediate supervisors. Overtime may be paid to allow attendance.

I. **SARU member Selection:** see also G-5230 Transfer and Assignment.

1. Minimum Requirements: The following requirements must be met to apply for a position in the Search and Rescue Unit.

a) Must have at least two (2) years of experience as a deputy with the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office.

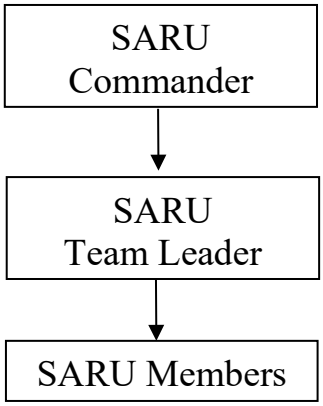
b) Availability for emergency call-out at any time.

c) Must be highly self-motivated and able to work individually and as a team.

d) Must not have a fear of heights or water.

e) Must possess a good sense of spatial direction.

f) Must be familiar with operating a boat, ATV, and/or motorcycle.

2. Training: An applicant may be provided a probationary position pending successful completion of an approved Search and Rescue training program.

Search and Rescue Unit Structure